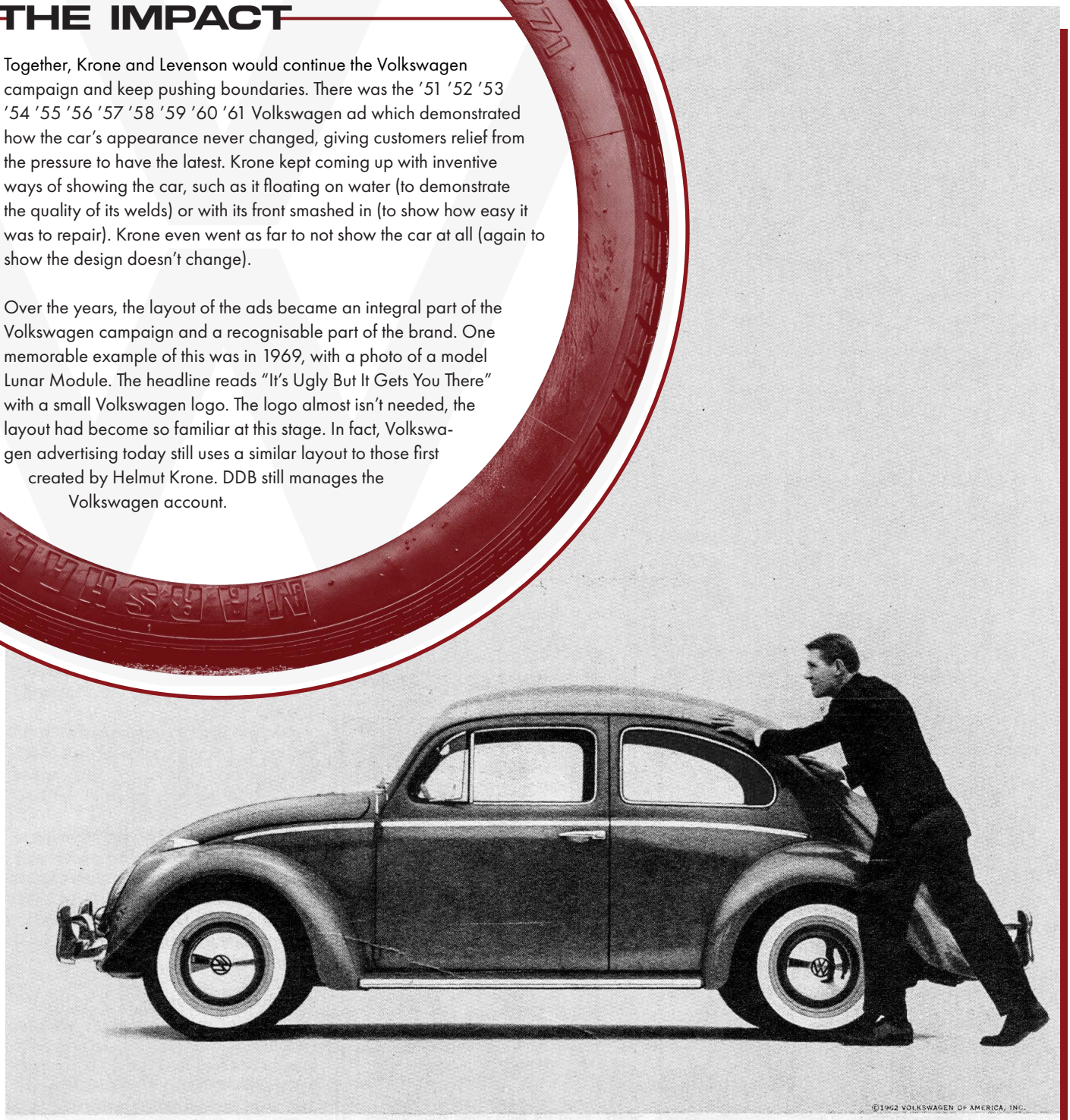
THE IMPACT

Together, Krone and Levenson would continue the Volkswagen campaign and keep pushing boundaries. There was the '51 '52 '53 '54 '55 '56 '57 '58 '59 '60 '61 Volkswagen ad which demonstrated how the car's appearance never changed, giving customers relief from the pressure to have the latest. Krone kept coming up with inventive ways of showing the car, such as it floating on water (to demonstrate the quality of its welds) or with its front smashed in (to show how easy it was to repair). Krone even went as far to not show the car at all (again to show the design doesn't change).

Over the years, the layout of the ads became an integral part of the Volkswagen campaign and a recognisable part of the brand. One memorable example of this was in 1969, with a photo of a model Lunar Module. The headline reads "It's Ugly But It Gets You There" with a small Volkswagen logo. The logo almost isn't needed, the layout had become so familiar at this stage. In fact, Volkswagen advertising today still uses a similar layout to those first created by Helmut Krone. DDB still manages the Volkswagen account.



And if you run out of gas, it's easy to push.

See?

We think of everything.

Getting a Volkswagen to the side of the road is a pushover.

It's a little surprising that VW owners don't run out of gas more often.

A figure like 32 miles to the gallon can make you a little hazy about when you last filled up.

And you spend so little time in gas stations, there are almost no reminders.

You'll probably never need oil between changes, for example.

You'll never need water or anti-freeze because the engine is air-cooled.

40,000 miles on a set of tires won't break any Volkswagen records.

And repairs are few and far between.

So this year we've installed a gas gauge to help you remember.

But we haven't taken all the fun away.

You still have to remember to look at it.